far.[38] This would, undoubtedly, disseminate the more realistic and reliable data, facilitating better decision making and policy intervention.

The revised series of WPI (base 2004–05=100) has also addressed the issue of flow of regular data. The NIC unit of the Office of the Economic Adviser has developed an online data transmission mechanism, whereby, the manufacturing units can supply price data through internet. Also, an arrangement has been made with National Sample Survey Office (Field Operations Division) to get price data on regular basis. These measures have improved the flow of price data.

The launch of the new series of WPI with base year 2004–05 has been one of the major initiatives of the Ministry of Commerce & Industry.

Since **November 2009** the WPI data are already being released in the following way:

(i) the first set of data of WPI (for the *'Manufacturing Products'*) are released on monthly basis.

(ii) the second set of data of WPI (for the *'Primary Articles'* and *'Energy and Fuel Group'*) are released on the weekly basis.

Consumer Price Index

Other than the WPI, India calculates the inflation at the consumer level also, similar to all the economies of the world. As the consumers in India show wide differentiation of their choice of consumption, purchasing powers etc a single consumer price index (CPI) has not been possible yet which can encompass all the Indian consumers.[39]

Depending upon the socioeconomic differentiations among the consumers India has four differing sets of the CPI with some differentials in the basket of commodities allotted to them. Though these four types of the CPIs is proposed to be withdrawn in coming times, data for them are still released. A brief account of the four CPIs are as under:

I. CPI-IW

The Consumer Price Index for the industrial workers (CPI-IW) has 260 items (plus the services) in its basket with 2001 as the base year[40] (the first